

Wally Crumbwell and the Recipe for Home

A baker's journey from the road to Cub Cakes & Crumbs





Come inside the story

A baker's journey from the road to Cub Cakes & Crumbs

Wally arrives with recipes and a basket of broken cookies. Follow a generous baker as he learns how to open a little shop, keep his kindness, and call Honeybrook home.

A little reading invitation

Read on your own, share a chapter aloud, or stop at a picture and look around. These adventures are here whenever you are ready.

Created for Templar Hughes-Bryant

Children's stories from Honeybrook. Established characters with expanded fictional journeys and imaginative illustrations.





Your adventure begins here

1. A Basket Full of Crumbs	3
2. The Baker with Too Many Buns	5
3. The Wind and the Basket	8
4. Supper without a Sales Pitch	10
5. Miss Patty's Question	12
6. The Little Shop	15
7. The First Batch	18
8. Enough for Today	21
9. The Recipe on the Wall	23
10. Crumbwell Comes Home	26





CHAPTER 01

1. A Basket Full of Crumbs

Wally Crumbwell arrived in Honeybrook with a recipe book, a mixing bowl, and a basket that smelled wonderfully of cookies.

Unfortunately, most of the cookies had broken on the road.

He opened the basket beside the bridge.

"Well," he said, "the flavor has traveled better than the shape."

A cub passing with a grown-up peered inside.

Wally offered them a clean wrapped portion from the unbroken corner. He explained that the rest were now cookie pieces.

The cub seemed delighted by this development.

Amelia came to greet him. Wally began telling her about his baking before remembering to tell her his name.

"Wally Crumbwell," he said. "I think the basket introduced me first."

She laughed and showed him the way to a place where he could rest.

Across the little town, he noticed smoke from kitchens, baskets carried along paths, and bears stopping to talk.





There was no bakery of his own waiting for him.

But there were neighbors who liked a warm cookie.

For a traveling baker, that seemed a promising beginning.





CHAPTER 02

2. The Baker with Too Many Buns

Before Honeybrook, Wally had worked in busy kitchens and baked for market stalls.

He loved the moment a tray came out golden. He loved watching someone take a bite and smile.

He was less good at remembering how many trays were needed.

If the order called for twenty buns, he sometimes made thirty, just in case.

If a neighbor looked hungry, he gave something away. If a child could not choose between two treats, he wanted to offer both.

Generosity made him happy.

It did not keep the flour cupboard full by itself.

At the last market he worked, his table looked beautiful in the morning and worryingly full by closing time. The weather had reduced the crowd, and he had baked for a crowd twice as large.

He shared what could safely be shared while it was fresh. Then he counted the supplies he had used.

The numbers made him sit down.





Wally did not stop loving baking. He began wanting a place where he could build a steadier life around it.

He had heard of Honeybrook's welcoming settlement.

He packed his recipes and what savings he had kept.

He also packed too many cookies for the journey.

Some habits traveled very faithfully.

Wally remembered a baker who had taught him to wait before judging a tray. The outside might look ready before the middle had finished, and rushing could waste ingredients as surely as making too much.

He had learned patience beside the oven.

He had not always carried it to the order book.

At a market table, excitement made him imagine that every passing bear would buy a bun. He wanted the table full because an empty place looked less friendly to him.

But a full table at closing meant work and supplies without enough sales to replace them.

Packing for Honeybrook, he copied his favorite recipes and left a clean page for what he needed to learn about a shop.

At the top he wrote: How much is enough?





It looked like a small question.

He suspected it would need more than one afternoon.





CHAPTER 03

3. The Wind and the Basket

The last part of the road had been windy.

Wally stopped at a covered bench, opened his recipe book, and checked the page for honey buns.

A gust lifted three loose slips tucked inside.

He caught one against his apron. Another landed in the basket. The third settled safely in a nearby bush, just far enough away to make him work for it.

While retrieving it, he bumped the basket with his elbow.

The cookies slid.

The top layer became pieces.

Wally looked at them and sighed.

He had packed carefully, but not carefully enough for his own busy paws.

He wrapped the portions again, checked that everything stayed clean, and continued. A road is not made shorter by arguing with a basket.





By the time he reached Honeybrook, he had decided what to call the broken treats.

Cookie crumbs sounded like an accident.

Cookie pieces sounded like a choice.

He knew which was true, though.

When Amelia asked how the journey had gone, he told her honestly.

That made her laugh more kindly than a grand story about a perfect arrival would have.





CHAPTER 04

4. Supper without a Sales Pitch

Wally sat at a table with Sammy, Amelia, and several neighbors.

He offered the cookies again, then began describing all the baking he could do if he were given a kitchen.

Bread. Buns. Biscuits. Tarts.

Possibly a very large celebration cake, though nobody had asked for one yet.

Amelia passed him supper.

"Rest first," she said.

Wally worried that a newcomer should show how useful he could be.

Sammy looked at him quietly.

"You can eat before explaining."

Wally did.

Afterward, Amelia asked what he hoped for. He described a bakery with a bright window and room for neighbors to stop.





She did not promise a finished shop the next morning. They would need to look at spaces, costs, equipment, and the town's needs.

But he could stay while making a plan.

Even if he changed the plan.

Wally thought about that as he washed his bowl.

He had come carrying recipes as if they were the key to a door.

The door had opened before anyone tasted a bun.



CHAPTER 05

5. Miss Patty's Question

Miss Patty Peaches heard about the new baker.

She visited with an empty basket and a very full list of questions.

Wally liked her immediately.

They talked about favorite flavors, morning customers, and how many bears passed through Main Street.

"How many buns would you bake for the first morning?" she asked.

Wally named a hopeful number.

Miss Patty blinked.

"How many customers are you expecting?"

He named a smaller number.

She looked at him over the basket.

Wally began to see the difficulty.

Templar helped him make a simple list: ingredients, likely sales, time, and a small amount of extra stock. She asked questions rather than laughing at the market mistake.



Professor Honeywell helped him check a calculation he had hurried through.

Wally could still share food. But he needed to decide what he could afford to share and keep the business able to bake tomorrow.

Miss Patty tapped the recipe book.

"I want your kindness to last longer than one tray."

Wally wrote that sentence on a clean card.

He put it beside the honey-bun recipe.

At the next meeting, they discussed what customers would actually see. Wally's first notice named seven products, though he had only planned to make three reliably.

Templar asked which ones would be ready on opening morning.

Wally circled three.

The notice became shorter and clearer.

Miss Patty suggested he describe special orders separately, with enough time to prepare them.

That felt less exciting than promising everything. It also felt more manageable.





Wally began understanding that a modest promise kept well could make a neighbor happier than a grand promise followed by confusion.

They checked the supply list again. He found a number he had copied incorrectly and corrected it before buying the ingredients.

Professor Honeywell congratulated him on checking, not on never making a mistake.

Wally went back to the little shop feeling hopeful in a steadier way.





CHAPTER 06

6. The Little Shop

The bakery began smaller than Wally's dream.

There was a counter, a few shelves, suitable kitchen equipment, and a window that caught the morning light.

Tom helped with the fittings. Buddy checked that the routes stayed clear. Wally learned where ingredients could be stored safely and how to keep the work area organized.

He found organization difficult when three new recipes appeared in his thoughts at once.

Miss Patty suggested he put the ideas in a notebook instead of putting all of them into the ovens.

Templar agreed enthusiastically, though Buddy looked at her own notebook and smiled.

Wally chose a name: Cub Cakes & Crumbs.

"The crumbs are included?" Lance asked.

"At no extra charge," Wally replied.





The children made a cheerful drawing for the window. Landis added a dinosaur beside a bun. Wally decided the bakery could survive this artistic choice.

On the evening before opening, he walked through the shop alone.

It was not enormous.

It was his first steady place for the work he loved.

He set the kindness card beside the ingredient list.

Tomorrow would need both.





Wally's first baking days bring surprises and new neighbors





CHAPTER 07

7. The First Batch

Wally's first morning began too early and too quickly.

He measured, mixed, shaped, checked, and forgot where he had put the pencil for his order list.

The pencil was behind his ear.

He found it just before asking Miss Patty to help search.

The first tray came out well. The second spread more than he expected.

Its cookies were very large.

Lance saw them through the window and stopped walking.

Landis stopped too.

Wally checked the batch and the ingredients before offering anything. They were safe to serve, but not the tidy little cookies he had planned.

He reviewed the recipe and realized his portions had been larger than the first tray's.

"A dramatic cookie," Miss Patty said.





Wally put an accurate description beside them rather than pretending they were the ordinary size.

The next tray used the correct portions.

Customers tried the buns, the small cookies, and the larger ones. They asked questions. Some returned later with a friend.

By afternoon Wally had made mistakes, corrected them, and learned more than his opening-day dream had included.

He had also remembered not to bake three extra trays simply because the morning felt exciting.

That was a new kind of pride.

When the last customer left, Wally sat behind the counter for a moment. He had imagined opening day as a long, shining line of compliments.

It had included compliments. It had also included a missing pencil, a changed tray, a question he needed to answer twice, and flour in places flour should not have reached.

Miss Patty helped him review the order list.

"What would you change tomorrow?"

Wally named three things. She wrote them down so the good ideas would not be forgotten in the morning rush.





Then she asked what he wanted to keep.

He looked toward the little window where the children had stopped.

"That feeling when someone comes in smiling."

Miss Patty nodded.

"Good. We can keep the welcome and improve the plan."

Wally cleaned the counter, closed the ingredient containers, and put the pencil somewhere he could find it.

Tomorrow would be his second opening day.

It did not need to pretend the first had been perfect.





CHAPTER 08

8. Enough for Today

For several days, Wally wrote down what sold.

A rainy morning was quieter. A busy market day brought more visitors. A large order needed a clear plan rather than a hopeful wave of the mixing spoon.

He began adjusting his quantities.

He still sometimes had leftovers. When there were fresh pastries suitable to share, he arranged deliveries to Welcome House and other agreed places.

He did not treat those deliveries as a reason to stop counting.

Sammy accepted a basket one afternoon and asked whether Wally had kept enough for his own supper.

Wally looked surprised.

"I was thinking about everyone else."

"You live here too," Sammy said.

Wally took one bun home.

That evening, he sat outside his little place with tea and his own baking. He had spent the day greeting customers, measuring





carefully, and cleaning surfaces that somehow collected flour no matter how tidy he tried to be.

Now there was nothing he needed to explain.

A neighbor passed and waved.

Wally waved back.

Tomorrow's ingredients were ready.

Today's bun was enough.



CHAPTER 09

9. The Recipe on the Wall

The bakery became part of Honeybrook's mornings.

Harold stopped between deliveries. Miss Patty collected café orders. Daisy Bellweather came in while still deciding what she wanted to do with her own life.

"Can I just sit?" Daisy asked once.

Wally pointed to a chair.

"Certainly."

He thought of his first supper and the way Sammy had told him he could eat before explaining.

Wally had begun by wanting everyone to love his baking. He was learning to enjoy a neighbor who simply needed a quiet corner too.

On a rainy afternoon, Templar helped him make a copy of the kindness card large enough for the kitchen wall.

Below it, Wally added a line of his own:

A GOOD RECIPE NEEDS CARE. A GOOD HOME MAKES ROOM.

Lance said the sign should also mention chocolate.



Wally took the suggestion seriously enough to offer him a small cookie.

Landis requested a dinosaur-shaped one.

"Another day," Wally said.

Miss Patty looked pleased.

He was learning that a cheerful baker could say another day and remain cheerful.

Daisy visited again when Wally was trying a new recipe. She asked whether every new idea became something in the shop.

"No," he admitted. "Some become notes about what not to repeat."

She looked pleased by that answer.

They talked about experiments, work, and the discomfort of still figuring things out. Wally did not offer to solve Daisy's whole future between two trays.

He offered a chair and listened.

Later, when she left, the test batch was ready. It needed another adjustment, so Wally recorded what he would try next time instead of putting it on sale as finished.





The clean page from his journey was filling with answers about enough.

Enough could mean enough ingredients for the real order, enough time to check a recipe, or enough quiet for a neighbor to think.

It did not mean he had stopped wanting good things.





CHAPTER 10

10. Crumbwell Comes Home

After closing one evening, Wally took the old traveling basket from a shelf.

One corner was worn. The handle bore a small mark from the windy journey.

He filled it with a modest order for Welcome House, checked the wrapping, and carried it down the path.

The wooden bridge stood where he had first opened the basket and laughed at the cookie pieces.

He paused beside it.

Once, the recipe book had seemed like proof that he deserved somewhere to stay.

Now it was simply a book full of work he loved, in a town that had welcomed him before the work began.

At Welcome House, Sammy opened the door.

"Come in."

Wally set the basket down and sat at the table.

A new traveler asked where he lived.





He almost began explaining the bakery.

Then he smiled.

"Honeybrook," he said.

The soup arrived.

For once, he did not offer to improve the menu before tasting it.





Story Note

Wally's generous, cheerful, messy character and Cub Cakes & Crumbs bakery are established Honeybrook details. His pre-arrival market work, journey, arrival, and bakery-opening story are new fictional backstory created for this collection. They have not been presented as previously agreed history.

